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Study of Ethnomedicinal plants related to family Euphorbiaceae in Ranchi District

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Abstract : The article represents traditional medicinal use of plants related to family Euphorebiaceae found in Ranchi District of Jharkhand. It was found that plants are used by local tribes and was found to be possess good healing properties. Formal surveys in the field and by the collection and identification of plants specimen used.

Key words: Euphorbiaceae, Khariya, Munda, Sadan, Pahan, Ojha, Traditional uses.

INTRODUCTION

The plants of family Euphorbiaceae are mostly monoecious herbs, shrubs, and trees. Some time succulent and cactus like It comprises fourth largest of all Angiosperm families and spread over 300 genera and 7500 species (John and Luchinger 1987) In our Ranchi District it is reported by several genera such as Phyllanthus , Euphorbia, Ricinus, Croton, Jatropha, Hevea etc. They are important source of products which are used in variety of industries including those of Pharmaceuticals, food, cosmetics, rubber etc. It also consists of a large no. of plants related to folk medicines. People those are living in interior and inaccessible remote rural areas have excellent knowledge about medicinal importance of local flora. Because of prompt and positive effect of herbal treatment , they have strong faith in their own medicnal preparations or crude formulation.

MATERIALS AND METHODS

Ethnomedicinal surveys were conducted from tribal areas including both urban and remote rural areas and informations were collected from the Khariyas, Mundas, Manakis, Sadans Pahans, Ojhas and local knowledgeable people. The research was clearly shown that tribal and rural people of Ranchi District depend on traditional healers and medicine man. Plants were identified with the help of books. Detailed informations regarding local names, botanical names, parts used and their medicinal uses were recorded. Herberia was prepared with all relevant informations which was deposited in P.G. Department of Botany, Ranchi college, Ranchi .

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

The survey of urben and remote rural areas revealed that the local populations are using about 13 plant species related to family Euphorbiaceae as medicine for different diseases in Ranchi District. There are 3 species whose entire parts are used .There are 2 species whose only leaves are used . There are 3 speces whose only seeds are used . There is 1 species whose fruit and 1 species whose latex are used. There is one species whose roots , leaves and fruits are used and another whose root , leaves flowers and seeds oil are used.

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Table 1 : List of some plants related to family Euphorbiaceae used in different diseases.

Sl. No.	Common name	Botanical name	Medicinal uses	Part used
1	Bhumi amla	*Phyllanthus niruri*	Entire plants used as bronchitis, asthma, splenic disorders, liver disorders, skin diseases, Jaundice, loss of appetite, fever, Diarrhoea, Dysentery and Leucorrhoea .	Entire plant
2	Amla	*Phyllanthus emblica*	Its fruits are very rich in vitamin C and used in diarrhea and dysentery . It is also used in the treatment of scurvy . .	Fruit
3	Arandi (red)	*Ricinus communis*	Used in abdominal discomfort, constipation, inflammation, cough leprosy skin diseases Oil is used as laxative, joint pain, rheumatism. It is purgativeits leaves are used in jaundice.	Roots, leaves, flowers, seeds oil
4	Baghrandi	*Jatropha curcas*	Its seeds are used as a purgative and also in a skin diseases, in rheumatism.	Seeds
5	Behranda	*Jatropha gosipifolia*	The mundas use it against urine troubles.	Seeds
6	Dudhi	*Euphorbia hirta*	Used as bronchitis, anthelmintic, bowel asthma, cough, promotes milk, gonorrhoea.	Entire plants
7	Sid daru	*Euphorbia nerifolia*	Used in muscular pain.	Leaves
8	Airi	*Euphorbia tithymaloides*	Used as a remedy for snake bite.	Fresh leaves
9	Jamalgota	*Croton sparciflorus*	Seeds oil are used as a puegative and also as insecticides .	Seeds
10	Pitonji	*Putranjiva roxburghii*	Used in burning sensation, constipation, filariasis, inflammations, habitual abortion sterility .	Root , leaves fruits
11	Simar kanda	*Manihot esculenta*	Used in skin diseases specially in children Used in fever and chills, to treat sterile women.	Leaves
12	Sinduri, kamala	*Mallotus philippinensis*	Useful in treatment of bronchitis, aabdominal diseases, spleen enlargement, worm infestation, constipation, skin diseases, wounds, ulcerscough, renal, ringworm and hemorrhage.	All parts
13	Poinsettia , cristmas flower	*Euphorbia pulcherrima*	Latex is used for a depilatory , pain relief , antibacterial , and emetic . It also include remedies for skin , warts and toothache Extracts of the pland have been used as an antipyretic and to stimulate the flow of breast milk .	Latex

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